

The Necklace

Guy de Maupassant · 1884

First published: Le Gaulois, Feb 1884 (tr. public-domain, 1903 Dunne edition)

TEACHER EDITION · CURRICULUM UNIT

One 90-minute lesson (the whole story), with an optional take-home essay
Syllabus · 90-minute lesson plans · lecture scripts · vocabulary · quizzes with keys · writing prompts at eleven rigor levels · SAT-style items · whole-book test · essays

Liber et Libri · Lux et Libri LLC

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Contents and unit overview

1. Unit overview and the 90-minute lesson
2. Syllabus (weekly pacing)
3. Lesson plans and lecture scripts (chapters 1–1), each with vocabulary, discussion questions, annotation focus, quiz and key, writing prompts and SAT-style items
4. Whole-book test and answer key
5. Essay assignments at eleven rigor levels

Edition: Reading text: https://en.wikisource.org/wiki/Stories_by_Foreign_Authors_(French_I)/The_Necklace (revision 13522838), cleaned for Liber et Libri.

Grades: Grades 7–10 (scales to graduate via rigor levels). Short story: read whole in one 90-minute lesson (assign longer stories as pre-reading). Middle School prompts use the full text when the grade tags include 6–8; otherwise teacher-selected passages. **Weeks:** 1. **Class days:** 1 × 90 minutes (1 chapter lessons plus seminar, test and essay days).

Essential questions

- What does The Necklace suggest about vanity and appearance?
- What does The Necklace suggest about class?
- What does The Necklace suggest about honesty?

Objectives

- Cite textual evidence to support analysis of what the text says explicitly and implicitly.
- Determine themes and analyze their development over the course of the story.
- Analyze how characters, setting and point of view interact.
- Determine the meaning of words and phrases as they are used in the text.
- Write arguments to support claims with clear reasons and relevant evidence.

Standards and frameworks

- **Common Core:** RL.7.2, RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2, RL.9-10.3, RL.9-10.4, RL.9-10.5, RL.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2, RL.11-12.4, RL.11-12.5, W.7.1, W.9-10.1, W.11-12.1, L.9-10.4, L.11-12.4
  Common Core State Standards (ELA-Literacy), thecorestandards.org
- **Indiana 2023:** 7.RC.2, 7.RC.3, 7.W.1, 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.RC.2, 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.RC.9, 9-10.RC.12, 9-10.W.1, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.4, 11-12.RC.11, 11-12.RC.13, 11-12.W.1
  Indiana Academic Standards, English/Language Arts (2023), IDOE

- **Dual Credit (Indiana College Core):** ICC-WC-1.1, ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.7
  Indiana College Core, Written Communication outcomes 1.1–1.7 (CHE guidance); ICC-WC-x IDs are ours
- **AP:** AP-LIT.CHR, AP-LIT.SET, AP-LIT.STR, AP-LIT.NAR, AP-LIT.FIG, AP-LIT.LAN
  AP English Literature and Composition big ideas (our summaries; apcentral.collegeboard.org)
- **Cambridge International:** CAIE-9695.AO1, CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO4, CAIE-9695.AO5
  Cambridge International AS & A Level Literature in English 9695 assessment objectives (our summaries; cambridgeinternational.org)
- **Liber et Libri program outcomes:** LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1
  Liber et Libri program outcome, not an official standard

Primary codes: RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2, RL.9-10.3, RL.9-10.4, RL.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2, RL.11-12.5, W.9-10.1, W.11-12.1, RL.7.2
Assessments: Daily story quizzes (auto-graded); Weekly writing prompt (rubric); Socratic seminars (scheduled days); Whole-story test (scheduled day); Final essay (scheduled day); College Sophomore and above write one essay of the five
Differentiation: Every prompt and quiz has eleven rigor levels (Middle School through Graduate / PhD); the app applies student override, then class standard, then the automatic level. Each prompt is tagged for Common Core, Indiana 2023, Dual Credit (Indiana College Core), AP and Cambridge where they apply.
Materials: Liber et Libri reader; Annotation journal; Story lecture slides or script

The 90-minute lesson

#	Segment	Mode	Minutes	Clock
1	Bell-ringer	You do	8	0–8
2	Vocabulary with etymology notes	I do	10	8–18
3	Background and context	I do	10	18–28
4	I do: modeled close reading	I do	12	28–40
5	We do: guided annotation	We do	15	40–55
6	You do: independent annotation	You do	15	55–70
7	Discussion	We do	10	70–80
8	Exit ticket / chapter quiz	You do	7	80–87
9	Closure	I do	3	87–90
	Total		**90**	

Syllabus

Week	Chapters	Lessons	Focus and activities	Assessment
1	The Necklace	1 × 90 min (90 min)	*vanity and appearance* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Story quizzes in the app • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt

Lesson plans and lecture scripts

Each chapter is one 90-minute class. Scripts are a starting point; adapt them to your students. Teacher summaries contain spoilers.

Lesson 1: The Necklace

Focus: the cost of wanting to seem richer than you are

Content note (): No significant sensitive content flagged; preview as usual.
Student preview: Nothing in this story needs a special warning.
Suggested language: "Why does the writer include this, and what does it make us notice?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Mathilde Loisel, a clerk's wife who dreams of luxury, borrows a diamond necklace from her rich friend Madame Forestier for a ministry ball. She loses it, and the Loisels secretly buy a replacement for 36,000 francs, sinking into poverty for ten years to repay the debt. Worn and aged, Mathilde meets Madame Forestier and tells her the truth. The original was paste, worth at most five hundred francs.

Background: Published in Le Gaulois in 1884. Translation: Jonathan Sturges, in The Odd Number (1889), public domain in the US.

Significance: One of the best-known twist endings; on Glencoe grade 9 lesson plans.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: Why do people sometimes pretend to be more than they are? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board. Before we start, a content note: Nothing in this story needs a special warning.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are bracelets, vestibule, contrasted, humiliating, homeward. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "She saw first of all some bracelets, then a pearl necklace, then a Venetian cross, gold, and precious stones of admirable workmanship." In this sentence it means: bands or chains worn around the wrist. Word histories: For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of The Necklace would have known. Published in Le Gaulois in 1884. Translation: Jonathan Sturges, in The Odd Number (1889), public domain in the US. Why does this story matter? One of the best-known twist endings; on Glencoe grade 9 lesson plans. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for irony.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: "She saw first of all some bracelets, then a pearl necklace, then a Venetian cross, gold, and precious stones of admirable workmanship." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to the cost of wanting to seem richer than you are? I circle "bracelets", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find irony, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for irony.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of irony. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *She saw first of all some bracelets, then a pearl necklace, then a Venetian cross, gold, and precious stones of admirable workmanship. She tried on the ornaments before the glass, hesitated, could not make up her mind to part with them, to give them back. She kept asking:*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Irony, Characterization, Theme: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how The Necklace develops the idea of the cost of wanting to seem richer than you are. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. Read in the public-domain translation by Jonathan Sturges.) I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions (focus set for the class level): wait time, think-pair-share on DOK 3/4, follow-up probes.
Let's talk. We move from what happens to why it matters to whether it's right. After each question I wait before calling on anyone: think first. Our anchor question: How does this story connect to vanity and appearance? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence, and end by writing one question of your own.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Story quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the story quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this story suggests about the cost of wanting to seem richer than you are, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how irony shapes the cost of wanting to seem richer than you are. Tonight, read the next story and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
bracelets (noun)	bands or chains worn around the wrist	*She saw first of all some bracelets, then a pearl necklace, then a Venetian cross, gold, and precious stones of admirable workmanship.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
vestibule (noun)	an entrance hall	*"Yes, I felt it in the vestibule of the palace."*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
contrasted (verb)	put in opposition to show or emphasize differences	*He threw over her shoulders the wraps which he had brought, modest wraps of common life, whose poverty contrasted with the elegance of the ball dress.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
humiliating (verb)	cause to feel shame; hurt the pride of	*"No; there's nothing more humiliating than to look poor among other women who are rich."*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
homeward (adjective)	oriented toward home	*It took them to their door in the Rue des Martyrs, and once more, sadly, they climbed up homeward.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
triumphant (adjective)	joyful and proud especially because of triumph or success	*But, one evening, her husband returned home with a triumphant air, and holding a large envelope in his hand.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
newspaper (noun)	a daily or weekly publication on folded sheets; contains news and articles and advertisements	*He went to Police Headquarters, to the newspaper offices, to offer a reward; he went to the cab companies—everywhere, in fact, whither he was urged by the least suspicion of hope.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
dismissed (verb)	sent away; released	*They dismissed their servant; they changed their lodgings; they rented a garret under the roof.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Why do people sometimes pretend to be more than they are?
2. Where does irony appear in this story, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this story connect to the book's larger concern with vanity and appearance?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19,

20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What is Mathilde's husband's job? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: A clerk in the Ministry of Public Instruction
2. Why does Mathilde borrow the necklace? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: To look rich at a ball
3. How long do the Loisels work to repay the debt? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Ten years
4. What happens to Mathilde's appearance? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: She becomes worn and coarse from hard work
5. What does Madame Forestier reveal? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: The original necklace was fake
6. Retell the three most important events of “The Necklace” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Mathilde Loisel, a clerk's wife who dreams of luxury, borrows a diamond necklace from her rich friend Madame Forestier for a ministry ball. She loses it, and the Loisels secretly buy a replacement for 36,000 francs, sinking into poverty for ten years to repay the debt. Worn and aged, Mathilde meets Madame Forestier and tells her the truth. The original was paste, worth at most five hundred francs.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “The Necklace”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the story; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does “The Necklace” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the story.
9. Reread: “She saw first of all some bracelets, then a pearl necklace, then a Venetian cross, gold, and precious stones of admirable workmanship.” What does “bracelets” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: bracelets: bands or chains worn around the wrist.
10. Reread: “"Yes, I felt it in the vestibule of the palace."” What does “vestibule” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: vestibule: an entrance hall.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “The Necklace” suggest about the cost of wanting to seem richer than you are? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: One of the best-known twist endings; on Glencoe grade 9 lesson plans.
2. Find one example of irony in this story. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.

3. How does the characterization in this story shape what we understand about the cost of wanting to seem richer than you are? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. In the passage that begins “She saw first of all some bracelets, then a pearl necklace, then a Venetian cross, gold, and precious stones of admirable workmanship.”, why might Maupassant have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “The Necklace”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Mathilde Loisel, a clerk's wife who dreams of luxury, borrows a diamond necklace from her rich friend Madame Forestier for a ministry ball. She loses it, and the Loisels secretly buy a replacement for 36,000 francs, sinking into poverty for ten years to repay the debt. Worn and aged, Mathilde meets…
6. As the opening story, what does “The Necklace” set up that the rest of The Necklace will need? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous story.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “Why do people sometimes pretend to be more than they are?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does theme appear, and how does it connect this story to the larger concern with vanity and appearance? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.
10. Background: Published in Le Gaulois in 1884. Translation: Jonathan Sturges, in The Odd Number (1889), public domain in the US. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the story? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “One of the best-known twist endings; on Glencoe grade 9 lesson plans.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the story. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
2. Which character in this story acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
3. Rewrite one moment of “The Necklace” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the cost of wanting to seem richer than you are? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
4. Write three questions of your own about “The Necklace”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

5. Connect this story to class: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Maupassant need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
6. Is the irony in this story effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
7. Compare how “The Necklace” treats the cost of wanting to seem richer than you are with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Necklace see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
8. As the final story, does this ending resolve vanity and appearance? Argue whether the ending is earned. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this story (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the cost of wanting to seem richer than you are? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
10. What question would you most like to ask Guy de Maupassant about this story, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz

1. What is Mathilde's husband's job?
   A. A clerk in the Ministry of Public Instruction
   B. A soldier
   C. A shopkeeper
   D. A banker
2. Why does Mathilde borrow the necklace?
   A. As a gift
   B. To look rich at a ball
   C. To copy it
   D. To sell it
3. How long do the Loisels work to repay the debt?
   A. Thirty years
   B. Ten years
   C. Six months
   D. One year

4. What happens to Mathilde's appearance?
   A. She becomes worn and coarse from hard work
   B. She becomes more beautiful
   C. She becomes rich
   D. She stays the same
5. What does Madame Forestier reveal?
   A. The original necklace was fake
   B. She knew all along
   C. She found the necklace
   D. She wants it back
6. In the line “She saw first of all some bracelets, then a pearl necklace, then a Venetian cross, gold, and precious stones of admirable workmanship.”, what does “bracelets” most nearly mean?
   A. an entrance hall
   B. cause to feel shame; hurt the pride of
   C. bands or chains worn around the wrist
   D. put in opposition to show or emphasize differences
7. In the line “"Yes, I felt it in the vestibule of the palace."”, what does “vestibule” most nearly mean?
   A. cause to feel shame; hurt the pride of
   B. an entrance hall
   C. put in opposition to show or emphasize differences
   D. bands or chains worn around the wrist

Answer key: 1. A (A clerk in the Ministry of Public Instruction); 2. B (To look rich at a ball); 3. B (Ten years); 4. A (She becomes worn and coarse from hard work); 5. A (The original necklace was fake); 6. C (bands or chains worn around the wrist); 7. B (an entrance hall)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.6, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.1, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this story is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “The Necklace,” how does Maupassant show the cost of wanting to seem richer than you are? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In The Necklace, how does Maupassant develop the idea of the cost of wanting to seem richer than you are? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the irony in the story helps build that idea. Read in the public-domain translation by Jonathan Sturges.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how The Necklace develops the idea of the cost of wanting to seem richer than you are. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and

characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. Read in the public-domain translation by Jonathan Sturges.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of The Necklace (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of the cost of wanting to seem richer than you are. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what The Necklace suggests about the cost of wanting to seem richer than you are. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the story's irony and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.NAR, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Guy de Maupassant uses irony in The Necklace to complicate the reader's understanding of the cost of wanting to seem richer than you are. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate The Necklace within its historical and literary context and argue how the story's treatment of the cost of wanting to seem richer than you are responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read The Necklace alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the story's handling of the cost of wanting to seem richer than you are follows or bends those conventions, using the irony as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to The Necklace and its treatment of the cost of wanting to seem richer than you are. State your method, show what it reveals in the story's irony and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads The Necklace as evidence for a larger claim about the cost of wanting to seem richer than you are in The Necklace. Connect close reading of the story to the whole story, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads The Necklace as a hinge in the story's larger treatment of the cost of wanting to seem richer than you are. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist,

historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Necklace.

SAT-style questions

1. *He threw over her shoulders the wraps which he had brought, modest wraps of common life, whose poverty contrasted with the elegance of the ball dress.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "contrasted" most nearly mean?

   A. a daily or weekly publication on folded sheets; contains news and articles and advertisements
   B. sent away; released
   C. put in opposition to show or emphasize differences
   D. joyful and proud especially because of triumph or success

2. *She saw first of all some bracelets, then a pearl necklace, then a Venetian cross, gold, and precious stones of admirable workmanship. She tried on the ornaments before the glass, hesitated, could not make up her mind to part with them, to give them back. She kept asking:*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "The Necklace"?

   A. Revenge carried out with perfect control
   B. The cost of wanting to seem richer than you are
   C. A reversal that punishes a change of heart
   D. A story told to protect a livelihood

SAT key: 1. C (put in opposition to show or emphasize differences); 2. B (The cost of wanting to seem richer than you are)

Whole-book test

The Necklace: whole-book test · 90 minutes

Part I: Multiple choice

1. What is Mathilde's husband's job?
   A. A clerk in the Ministry of Public Instruction
   B. A soldier
   C. A shopkeeper
   D. A banker
2. Why does Mathilde borrow the necklace?
   A. As a gift
   B. To look rich at a ball
   C. To copy it
   D. To sell it
3. How long do the Loisels work to repay the debt?
   A. Thirty years
   B. Ten years
   C. Six months
   D. One year
4. What happens to Mathilde's appearance?
   A. She becomes worn and coarse from hard work
   B. She becomes more beautiful
   C. She becomes rich
   D. She stays the same
5. What does Madame Forestier reveal?
   A. The original necklace was fake
   B. She knew all along
   C. She found the necklace
   D. She wants it back
6. In the line “She saw first of all some bracelets, then a pearl necklace, then a Venetian cross, gold, and precious stones of admirable workmanship.”, what does “bracelets” most nearly mean?
   A. an entrance hall
   B. cause to feel shame; hurt the pride of
   C. bands or chains worn around the wrist
   D. put in opposition to show or emphasize differences

7. In the line “"Yes, I felt it in the vestibule of the palace."”, what does “vestibule” most nearly mean?
   A. cause to feel shame; hurt the pride of
   B. an entrance hall
   C. put in opposition to show or emphasize differences
   D. bands or chains worn around the wrist
8. As used in the story (“She saw first of all some bracelets, then a pearl necklace, then a Venetian cross, gold, and precious stones of admirable workmanship.”), what does “bracelets” mean?
   A. bands or chains worn around the wrist
   B. oriented toward home
   C. sent away; released
   D. cause to feel shame; hurt the pride of
9. As used in the story (“"Yes, I felt it in the vestibule of the palace."”), what does “vestibule” mean?
   A. joyful and proud especially because of triumph or success
   B. an entrance hall
   C. bands or chains worn around the wrist
   D. oriented toward home
10. As used in the story (“He threw over her shoulders the wraps which he had brought, modest wraps of common life, whose poverty contrasted with the elegance of the b”), what does “contrasted” mean?
    A. a daily or weekly publication on folded sheets; contains news and articles and advertisements
    B. an entrance hall
    C. put in opposition to show or emphasize differences
    D. joyful and proud especially because of triumph or success
11. As used in the story (“"No; there's nothing more humiliating than to look poor among other women who are rich."”), what does “humiliating” mean?
    A. sent away; released
    B. put in opposition to show or emphasize differences
    C. a daily or weekly publication on folded sheets; contains news and articles and advertisements
    D. cause to feel shame; hurt the pride of
12. As used in the story (“It took them to their door in the Rue des Martyrs, and once more, sadly, they climbed up homeward.”), what does “homeward” mean?
    A. oriented toward home
    B. bands or chains worn around the wrist
    C. cause to feel shame; hurt the pride of
    D. sent away; released

Part II: Short answer

1. Explain how vanity and appearance develops from the beginning of the story to the end. Use two passages.
2. Explain how class develops from the beginning of the story to the end. Use two passages.
3. Explain how honesty develops from the beginning of the story to the end. Use two passages.

Part III: Essay

Choose one of the story's central concerns (vanity and appearance, class, honesty) and argue how the ending reframes it.

Answer key

Answer key: 1. A (A clerk in the Ministry of Public Instruction); 2. B (To look rich at a ball); 3. B (Ten years); 4. A (She becomes worn and coarse from hard work); 5. A (The original necklace was fake); 6. C (bands or chains worn around the wrist); 7. B (an entrance hall); 8. A (bands or chains worn around the wrist); 9. B (an entrance hall); 10. C (put in opposition to show or emphasize differences); 11. D (cause to feel shame; hurt the pride of); 12. A (oriented toward home)

Essay assignments

Essay: Vanity and appearance

Middle School (600 words; Common Core: W.7.1, RL.7.2; Indiana 2023: 7.W.1, 7.RC.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Necklace teaches about vanity and appearance. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Guy de Maupassant develops vanity and appearance in The Necklace. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Guy de Maupassant develops vanity and appearance across The Necklace. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.3; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Necklace (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of vanity and appearance. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO5): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of vanity and appearance in The Necklace. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; AP: AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Guy de Maupassant's choices in The Necklace (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of vanity and appearance, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Necklace's treatment of vanity and appearance in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on vanity and appearance in The Necklace that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on vanity and appearance in The Necklace. Name your critical

method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about vanity and appearance in The Necklace, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on vanity and appearance in The Necklace, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Class

Middle School (600 words; Common Core: W.7.1, RL.7.2; Indiana 2023: 7.W.1, 7.RC.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Necklace teaches about class. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Guy de Maupassant develops class in The Necklace. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Guy de Maupassant develops class across The Necklace. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.3; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Necklace (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of class. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO5): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of class in The Necklace. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; AP: AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Guy de Maupassant's choices in The Necklace (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of class, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Necklace's treatment of class in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on class in The Necklace that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on class in The Necklace. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about class in The Necklace, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on class in The Necklace, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Honesty

Middle School (600 words; Common Core: W.7.1, RL.7.2; Indiana 2023: 7.W.1, 7.RC.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Necklace teaches about honesty. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Guy de Maupassant develops honesty in The Necklace. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Guy de Maupassant develops honesty across The Necklace. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.3; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Necklace (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of honesty. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO5): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of honesty in The Necklace. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; AP: AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Guy de Maupassant's choices in The Necklace (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of honesty, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Necklace's treatment of honesty in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on honesty in The Necklace that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on honesty in The Necklace. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about honesty in The Necklace, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on honesty in The Necklace, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Original Liber et Libri curriculum. Quotations from the public-domain text. Vocabulary definitions are modern and contextual (curated; based on Princeton WordNet 3.0). Word histories appear only where verified (Online Etymology Dictionary, 2026-10-20); other words are student look-ups. AP and Cambridge entries are our own summaries with links, not College Board or Cambridge text; ICC-WC and LeL IDs are Liber et Libri labels. Included with every curriculum purchase and with Classroom Pro.